



Cavs vs. Pacers
Cavs fall 92-90, B6



MORNING JOURNAL SPORTS

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Shoremens fall short of SWC

Bulldogs win game, conference

By JASON LLOYD
Morning Journal Writer

AVON LAKE — Those hands that pushed Avon Lake within one night of a Southwestern Conference championship ...

Those hands that were already responsible for 24 points on this night ...

Those hands that wanted to touch an SWC trophy before graduation ...

As it all slipped away, Brian Ingleright was now cursing those same hands.

Olmsted Falls 81, Avon Lake 72.

Six straight SWC titles for the Bulldogs. One goal lost for the Shoremens.

"This is pretty devastating," Ingleright said. "It's hard to lose the league like this."

Avon Lake finishes 17-3 overall, 12-2 in the SWC. The Bulldogs are 15-4 overall, 13-1 in the conference with a meaningless non-conference game left tonight.

"We played hard in the second half," Ingleright said. "But it wasn't enough."

It wasn't enough because of the 46-31 hole the Shoremens jumped in by halftime.

"We knew we'd have to play very good to win," Ingleright said. "But in the first half we played pretty bad."

But Ingleright and Tom Port tried to forgive that bad half with a furious second-half return.

Port on a rebound and basket.

Ingleright with a 3-pointer from the concession stand.

Port on a dunk.

Ingleright with a runner

through the lane.

"We wanted to contain Port, and that didn't work. Then we wanted to contain Ingleright, and that didn't work," Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue said. "Finally we thought we better just outscore them."

With "Mike Gansey and his Merry Men," as Donahue called them, it's not a bad idea.

Port brought the sellout crowd to its feet early in the third with a monster dunk, but Falls' Joe Stanton ran right back down the floor with a twisting runner through the lane.

Ingleright slashed through the lane with a short runner, but Gansey came right back with a basket high off the glass.

"Overall in the second half we played well," Avon Lake coach Dave Olinger said. "We eventually cut the lead to five."

And it was then that Ingleright cursed the hands that brought the Shoremens so far.

Avon Lake shot and shot and shot that 15-point deficit down to five. After a Gansey free throw made it 74-68, Ingleright looked at the 1:30 that remained on the clock and heaved another 3-pointer in front of Olinger. It's these long 3-pointers that makes Olinger cringe at times, but it's those same 3-pointers that brought the Shoremens back last night.

"Coach always tells me to be patient," Ingleright says. "But if I feel like I can knock down my shot, I'll shoot 'em."

He had already made four of those bombs. A fifth would cut the Bulldogs lead to just three and set up a sequel to the buzzer-beating showstopper these two teams staged just last month, when Avon Lake handed Falls its only conference loss of the year.

But this time the sweat had caught up with Ingleright.



Avon Lake's Brian Ingleright, right, glides through the lane while attempting a layup in front of Joe Stanton of Olmsted Falls yesterday in the second half.

See **SHOREMEN**, page B5

Lytwyn leads Eagles

By JIM HORVATH
Morning Journal Correspondent

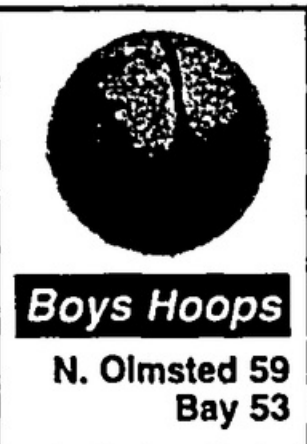
BAY VILLAGE — Last night, the Bay Rockets did their best interpretation of the Charles Dickens classic "A tale of Two Cities."

"It was the best of times, it was the worst of times..."

Indeed.

The Rockets held a six-point lead in the first quarter, then came out with leads of 10 and 13 in the third quarter. But North Olmsted, behind 24 points from Will Lytwyn, rallied in the fourth for a 59-53 Southwestern Conference win to close out the regular season.

Both teams finished 6-8 in the



MORNING JOURNAL/DOUGLAS A. KHRENOVSKY
Dave O'Neill, left, of Lake Ridge has his shot blocked by Tori Davis of Open Door.

See **EAGLES**, page B5

Patriots reach school record

Earn 19th win of season

By DAVE DARR
Morning Journal Correspondent

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — Lake Ridge Academy's senior night was spoiled as visiting Open Door pulled out its 18th straight win.

"They were well prepared, I give Lake Ridge a lot of credit on how they played tonight," Open Door coach Alan Januzzi said.

The Patriots came out of the gate very slow. Thad Davis was held scoreless in the first quarter, however Open Door still had a 11-10 lead. Royals' big man Dan O'Neill had six of his team high 11 points in the first quarter.

Picking up the slack for Open Door were Tori Davis and Dan Riley. Tori had seven of his 11 points in the second quarter. Riley scored all eight of his points in the first half.

Going into half-time with a 25-23 lead, Open Door turned to its star, Thad. On the opening possession in the second half, Tori got a steal and dished the ball to his brother Thad who slammed down a two-handed dunk. The dunk got Thad going as he had 12 points in the second half to keep the Patriots ahead for good.

The Royals cut it as close as one point, but never took the lead. With the final score of 49-



See **PATRIOTS**, page B5



JIM INGRAHAM

This season could decide Manuel's fate

Let us now speak the unspeakable.

What if the Indians this year do the very doable?

What if they miss the playoffs again?

I know what you're thinking: "Good grief, man! Are you mad?"

And you might have a point. I HAVE been feeling a little flush lately, but that might just be from seeing Jerry Spradlin in an Indians uniform again.

It's too early to tell.

But for the sake of argument — and you know how much madmen like to argue — let's say the Indians in 2001 achieve the exact same thing they achieved in 2000.

Nothing.

What if, come October, the Indians are hitting golf balls instead of baseballs?

Again.

What then?

Does Charlie Manuel become an ex-manager? Is Manuel under the gun in 2001?

Would missing the playoffs in consecutive years for the first time in nearly a decade be grounds for the Indians to change managers for the first time in, uh, 24 months?

Keep this in mind: if you look up the word "patience" in the dictionary, you will not

See **INGRAHAM**, page B3

NFL COMBINE

Deuce wants second shot with Davis

By JEFF SCHUDEL
Morning Journal Writer

INDIANAPOLIS — This time if Butch Davis comes calling, Deuce McAllister plans to answer "Yes!"

McAllister, a running back from the University of Mississippi, grew up in Morton, Miss. Davis tried to recruit McAllister to the University of Miami, but McAllister turned him down.

"If Miami was closer to my home, I probably would have gone there," McAllister said yesterday. "But it was too far away for my family and friends to come watch me play."

McAllister hopes the Browns use the third pick of the April 21 draft on him so he can finally get the chance to play for Davis. The 6-1, 219-pounder says he can be the complete running back the Browns need.

"I think I can carry the ball 25, 30 times a game, split out wide on third down and still help out on special teams," McAllister said. "I've never played a 20-game season, 24 with the playoffs, so that's something I'll have to get used to. I'll talk to my teammates and learn how to

See **DEUCE**, page B3

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